

Work Placement (Pharmaceutical Science)

Science

May, 2026

Work Placement (Pharmaceutical Science) (A26641)

Short Title:	Work Placement (Pharm Science)	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Science	
Cluster	Placement and Projects	
Author	HHUGHES	
Credits	30	Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

Students will be placed for work experience in a pharmaceutical or related company or a research laboratory for approximately nine months, between January and September of the third year of their programme. The nine months placement is designed to meet the needs of industry, but a minimum of 15 weeks placement is required to gain the credits for the module. The placement is designed to allow learners to apply and develop their knowledge and skills in a pharmaceutical company or related environment, working to accredited quality standards, thus enhancing their professional development. The placement will be supervised by a WIT lecturer and an industrial supervisor. Each student is expected to monitor their own performance by maintaining a weekly activity and reflection journal. Additionally, they will be required to submit a final report (assignment) on their placement detailing what they did and the skills they learned. The employer submits an evaluation of the students work at the end of the placement. Placement is assessed on a pass/fail basis. In order to gain credits for this module, the student must submit all relevant documentation to the placement coordinator. A mid-placement review will take place in the form of a site visit by the academic supervisor, where feasible, with on-going monitoring of the student by the industrial supervisor. Any problems will be dealt with in a timely manner.

Programmes

PLAC-0173 BSc (Hons) in Pharmaceutical Science (WD_SPHSC_B)

3 / 6 / E

Indicative Content

- Work placement in pharmaceutical or related company or research laboratory, with exposure to a range of laboratory and scientific activities
- Exposure to a range of laboratory techniques working to Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) in a Good Laboratory Practice (GLP) context & ability to carry out work following instructions, according to these SOPs
- Preparation of reports, both oral and written, on work carried out over an extended time frame, including maintenance of a weekly activity and reflection journal
- Presentation of reports at seminar and oral, if appropriate
- Assessment of the quality systems that apply in a regulated pharmaceutical company (or research equivalent) in the context of knowledge acquired in the course content of the degree programme
- Interpretation and critical evaluation of results of scientific experimentation
- Ability to work individually and as part of a team

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Plan for an interview to secure placement.
2. Plan learning objectives for the placement.
3. Operate independently and/or as part of a team towards the set objectives of the pharmaceutical / Healthcare or related enterprise.
4. Apply competently their pharmaceutical knowledge and skills in a range of settings.
5. Practise safely pharmaceutical / Healthcare related skills and employ good manufacturing practices.
6. Examine their personal, professional and technical achievements on the placement.
7. Communicate their activities and assessment of the pharmaceutical / Healthcare or related enterprise in a professional manner.
8. Critically reflect upon their learning experiences by using weekly reflective logs as a self-assessment tool and produce an end-of-placement written report (assignment).

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Training in laboratory work carried out in a regulated environment working to accredited good laboratory practice (GLP) standards.
- Reporting of scientific data and analysis to GLP standards.
- Scientific report and self-assessment using a weekly activity and reflection journal.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>Employer's Report</i>	50%	3,4,5
<i>Reflective Journal</i>	25%	1,2,6,7,8
<i>Essay</i>	25%	1,2,6,7,8

Assessment Criteria

Fail: Student fails to undertake or complete placement to a satisfactory level and/or fails to submit the assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes.

Pass: Minimum period of at least 15 weeks placement completed, satisfactory Supervisors Evaluation Report submitted, as well as assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes, all to an acceptable standard and submitted within deadlines.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Placement	810	